

RailVision Shortline Railroad Market Enumeration — One-Page Summary

Date / Context

Internal market enumeration exercise. Built to approximate the size and structure of the North American shortline railroad segment. Counts and attributes are indicative, not authoritative.

Purpose

To reason about the scale, fragmentation, and commercial accessibility of the shortline railroad market. Supports go-to-market prioritization, not census accuracy.

What This Is

- Rough enumeration of shortline operators
- High-level segmentation by ownership or footprint
- Order-of-magnitude market understanding tool

Key Assumptions

- Public and inferred counts are incomplete
- Operator definitions may vary
- Some entities may be double-counted or excluded

What the Model Suggests (Directional)

- The shortline market is large but fragmented
- Aggregators materially affect reach and scale
- Commercial leverage differs widely by owner

What Is True

- Shortlines represent a distinct buying persona vs Class I
- Enumeration precision is less important than structure

What Is Assumed

- Available listings approximate reality
- Market structure remains relatively stable

What This Enables the Agent to Answer

- “How fragmented is the shortline market?”
- “Why focus on aggregators?”

What This MUST NOT Be Used to Answer

- Exact customer counts
- Market share calculations
- Definitive TAM figures

Safety Classification

Authority Level: Low

Confidence Type: Approximate / Structural

Safe for External QA: No

Requires Explicit Qualifiers: Always